Lesson 25 material: Writing a Profile; Project Part 2: Personal Profile

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 2: Getting to Know You

3.2: Analyze a Profile

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Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/Getting_to_Know_You_-_An_Intermediate_Integrated-Skills_Module_for_English_Learners_(Ferguson)/03%3A_Chapter_3/3.2%3A_Analyze_a_Profile
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Analyze a Profile

In this chapter, you have had the opportunity to read and watch several profiles. On this page, we will summarize the types of profiles and analyze the rhetorical features of a profile.

In the spaces below, decide if the profile you read was an employee/intern profile, a student profile, or a profile of a famous person. Consider the institution that published each profile to help you decide.

Leslie Reynolds_____

Cody Gibson_____

Jennifer Moy _____

Felipe Valdez_____

Brandon Stanton_____

Diana Nyad _____

In the spaces below, write the focus of each profile. Choose from these four:

Career accomplishments and goals

Educational accomplishments and goals

Artistic process

Passion (a strong interest)

Leslie Reynolds_____

Cody Gibson_____

Jennifer Moy _____

Felipe Valdez_____

Brandon Stanton_____

Diana Nyad_____

Each of the profiles highlights the values of the subject. Match the values that you believe are most important to each subject.

Diana Nyad	Felipe Valdez	Brandon Stanton	Cody Gibson	Jennifer Moy	learning about people	adventures and travel	designing buildings	strength and persistence	research in mechanical engineering

Which of the profiles you read or watched was the most interesting to you? Why?

Review these questions from section 1.1. Can you answer them with more confidence now?

- A profile is:
  - About one person
  - About many people
- A profile is:
  - Short
  - Long
- A profile has:
  - A person's whole life history
  - A few facts about the person's history
- A profile focuses on:
  - One part of a person's life, such as work, school, a hobby, or a special interest
  - Everything that is important to that person
- A profile has:

- A negative tone
- A positive tone

- A profile is about:
  - Someone famous
  - Anyone

Analyze the features of a profile

Examine the reading about Leslie Reynolds again and notice the parts (features) of the profile that are common.

Leslie Reynolds Profile

The first sentence with the reason for the profile

- Congratulations to the 2015 recipient of the Harry Yount National Park Ranger Award!

Photo and caption

(Picture: Leslie Reynolds)

- Leslie Reynolds, Chief Ranger, Cape Cod National Seashore, Massachusetts

The "big picture" and focus of the profile (career, studies, art, hobby, etc.)

- After a visit to the Grand Canyon, Leslie Reynolds was hooked. Her love of national parks would take her on an incredible journey of public service and adventures in parks across the country.

History and achievements related to the focus of the profile (her career)

- Beginning as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park, Reynolds went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents.
- Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped develop the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen.

Current and future predictions or wishes for success

- As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to inspire the new generation of park rangers and lead through example.

Quote from the interviewee related to the focus of the profile...

- "I consider myself very fortunate to have chosen a career that is rewarding, that I am proud of, and one that continues to challenge me every day," said Reynolds. "My inspiration comes mostly from the rangers of the National Park Service with whom I have had the great honor of working with for the past twenty years. One of the most rewarding aspects of my profession is developing and mentoring others and watching them succeed, grow, and contribute to the ranger profession."

Now examine the profile about Jennifer Moy. Can you find some or all of the same features of a profile? Which features are missing?

Student Spotlight--Meet Jennifer Moy

Posted on November 20, 2019 by Christopher Larson

Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan. Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.

Figure: Jennifer Moy

Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library, and has helped make them happen.

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday." We're looking forward to that day Jennifer!

Rhetorical analysis answer key

4.2: Analyze a Profile Key

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Analyze a Profile

What is a profile? Examine the reading about Leslie Reynolds again and notice the parts (features) of the profile that are common...

Leslie Reynolds Profile

The first sentence with the reason for the profile...

- Congratulations to the 2015 recipient of the Harry Yount National Park Ranger Award!

Photo and caption...

(Picture: Leslie Reynolds)

- Leslie Reynolds, Chief Ranger, Cape Cod National Seashore, Massachusetts

The "big picture" and focus of the profile (career, studies, art, hobby, etc.)...

- After a visit to the Grand Canyon, Leslie Reynolds was hooked. Her love of national parks would take her on an incredible journey of public service and adventures in parks across the country.

History and achievements related to the focus of the profile (her career)...

- Beginning as a law enforcement ranger in Yosemite National Park, Reynolds went on to work at Grand Canyon and Shenandoah National Parks, serving these parks as an officer, medic, instructor, investigator, and even counselor. She has stepped up in many life-saving situations in her 21-year career; she has helped save hikers suffering from heat exhaustion in the Grand Canyon, injured climbers stuck and needing helicopter rescue, and victims of serious motor vehicle accidents.
- Because she understands that prevention and education is effective in saving lives, Reynolds helped develop the Preventative Search & Rescue (PSAR) programs at Yosemite and Shenandoah National Parks. She has also served as a member of the Critical Incident Stress Management Team, responding to numerous major traumatic events and helping team members cope with what they have been through and seen.

Current and future predictions or wishes for success...

- As the current chief ranger at Cape Cod National Seashore, Reynolds continues to inspire the new generation of park rangers and lead through example.

Quote from the interviewee related to the focus of the profile...

- "I consider myself very fortunate to have chosen a career that is rewarding, that I am proud of, and one that continues to challenge me every day," said Reynolds. "My inspiration comes mostly from the rangers of the National Park Service with whom I have had the great honor of working with for the past twenty years. One of the most rewarding aspects of my profession is developing and mentoring others and watching them succeed, grow, and contribute to the ranger profession."

Now examine the profile about Jennifer Moy. Can you find some or all of the same features of a profile? Take notes on each part of the profile. Which features are missing?

Student Spotlight--Meet Jennifer Moy

Posted on November 20, 2019 by Christopher Larson

Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan. Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.

Figure: Jennifer Moy

Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library, and has helped make them happen.

Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering: "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday." We're looking forward to that day Jennifer!

Answers

This section suggests the focus of the profile will be Jennifer's choice of major...

- Her long commute to school presented an opportunity to see the city in new ways. Gazing up at the monoliths, she was awe-inspired by the architecture and structures that surrounded her.

These parts show Jennifer's history and how she is connected to the library. The focus is on her choices related to education (major, college)...

- Originally from the Bronx, at the age of fourteen, Jennifer and her family moved to Brooklyn, NY. Jennifer had attended Frank McCourt High School, a small school located on the Upper West Side of Manhattan.
- When it came time to decide which college to attend, Jennifer was undecided between City College and Stony Brook University--she had already been accepted into the City College Engineering program. Despite this, Jennifer chose Stony Brook University as her new home. In truth she did not want to attend college in the city, plus the adventure of dormitory living was far more appealing.
- Jennifer started her first semester at Stony Brook University during the summer of 2017 through the Educational Opportunity Program (EOP). In her freshman year her major remained undeclared, but the following year she chose Civil Engineering. In her first year, Jennifer got a job at the Health Sciences Library. Since that time, she has seen some really wonderful changes at the library, and has helped make them happen.

A quote from the interviewee is very common at the end of a profile...

- "I grew up in a city full of towers and skyscrapers and it fascinates me how beautiful these structures are, and it inspires and motivates me to contribute to the structural architecture of a city building someday."

Current and future predictions /wishes for success...

- Jennifer is ready to graduate with her bachelor's degree by May 2021 and wants to specialize in structural engineering:
- We're looking forward to that day Jennifer!

Photo and caption...

- Jennifer Moy

Discussion Points for the Instructor

The second profile has many of the same features as Reynold's profile, including the photo, quote, current and future good wishes, and history.

The student spotlight does not have the opening 'hook' that is often present in profiles and is missing an introductory sentence that tells the reader why this person is being profiled. Which version do students prefer?

The subject of the profile is different from Reynold's profile, and since Jennifer Moy is a student and has fewer accomplishments so far, the focus is on her choices in education, which other students at Stony Brook might relate to. Her connection to the library is not emphasized as strongly as Reynold's connection to the National Park Service, because she is not receiving an award for twenty years of service. The audience also differs. Perhaps the student spotlight appeals to other students, inviting them to work at the library or visit the library. The Reynold's profile might be a motivational text for career employees at the NPS or a promotional text to showcase the strength of the staff at NPS to funding agencies.

3.3: Classmate Profile: Writing Assignment

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Writing Assignment

For this assignment, you will interview a classmate and write a profile about that classmate.

For the interview and profile, you will need:

- Paper for notes and a pen or pencil
- A phone or other recording device
- An English dictionary
- A list of questions

Initial Interview

Your instructor will pair you with a classmate. Ask your classmate the following questions. Take notes.

1. What is your full name?
2. Where and when were you born?
3. What is your current living situation (who do you live with and where)?
4. What do you think are the two most important events that happened in your life?
5. Tell me about two activities that interest you most.

Writing Interview Questions

On your own paper, write 15 questions that you can ask your classmate. Under each question, leave space for notes.

Use the answers to number 4 and 5 above to focus your questions. In other words, if your partner tells you they are interested in sports, write several questions about sports such as 'What type of sports do you like?' and 'Why do you like....?'

Write open-ended questions. Open-ended questions invite a longer and more detailed answer, and often start with 'how,' or 'why.'

Second Interview

Interview your classmate. Follow the suggestions below.

- Interview your classmate and take notes on their answers to the questions.
- Consider using a recording device.
- Follow Celeste Headlee's advice and be a good listener.
- To start the interview, ask your classmate the standard background information to get the name, place he or she was born, age, etc.
- Ask your 15 questions
- Use open-ended questions and follow up questions; try to get more detail. For example, if you ask, "Do you like your job?" and he answers "yes," follow up with, "Why do you like it?" If he responds, "Because it gives me a lot of free time," follow up with, "What do you like to do in your free time and why do you enjoy it?"
- You can ask for more information after the interview. Ask you classmate for their contact information so you can email, call or text them with any questions you think of later.

Writing the Profile

Write a profile about your classmate. Use the information you learned from reading and watching profiles in the Chapter Exploring Profiles and analyzing profiles in What is a Profile.

- Use your notes to write the profile. Be sure that the profile:
  - Is one to two pages with double-spaced lines
  - Keeps your audience, genre, and purpose in mind as you write the profile
  - Audience: Your classmates
  - Genre: Profile
  - Purpose: To convince other students about the interesting lives of students in the class

Grading Criteria

Follow the bullet points in the grading rubric below about how to write a profile. A grid rubric is attached.

- Content (30 points) Your profile should...

    - Have a focus on one positive aspect of your classmate (his or her education goal, a past or present important life experience, an important value(s), etc.)
    - Include at least two of the following: The history of this person's achievements, a description of the person or what their life was in the past or what is happening in the present, a photo, or a quotation from the person
    - Be one to two pages double-spaced
    - Be based on the interview questions and answers
    - Reveal a rich and interesting conversation with the person you interviewed
- Organization/Format (15 points) Your profile should...
    - Start with a sentence that shows the focus of the profile
    - Include the person's first name in the first or second sentence
    - Use at least two signal words for cohesion and coherence
    - Look like a profile (see the examples in Chapter 1 and 2)
- Vocabulary/Style/Tone (20 points) Your profile should...
    - Have a formal, positive and friendly tone
    - Use the third person voice (the person's name and he/she/"my classmate")
    - Be written in your own words. Do not copy from any other source
    - Use sufficient vocabulary to describe your classmate and the focus in detail
- Grammar and Sentence Structure (25 points) Your profile should...
    - Use the verb tenses needed to talk about your classmate and his/her life events (present simple and continuous, past simple and continuous, and future)
    - Include a variety of sentence types
    - Be carefully edited for accuracy
- Mechanics (5 points) Your profile should...
    - Use correct capitalization, punctuation (periods, commas, etc.) and spelling
- Notes/Mind Map (5 points)
    - Have sufficient and accurate notes taken before writing to complete the writing task

Profile Grading Rubric, Grid format

Links on the original page

- Profile Grading Rubric, Grid format: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1_5imNEEq7hrt4PE5hLxqUp1456KpOXGCzr-dUnLOOro/edit?usp=sharing

2.8: Unit Project Part 2- Personal Profile

From *Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level* by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0). This section: CC BY 4.0; authored, remixed or curated by Brittany Zemlick.
Original page, with audio and online exercises:
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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Project: Personal Profile

Task

1. Write a 1-2 paragraph summary talking about the person you interviewed. Practice reading it several times. Memorize your presentation and make a video of yourself talking about this person.
2. Include the following:
   - Give the person's name.
   - Explain what the person does in his or her job each day.
   - Say what the person does in his/her free time.
   - Say what the person values most in life.
3. Make a note of -s endings and appropriate places to use linking in your transcript. You must submit your transcript along with your video.
4. Make a video of yourself presenting your summary. Focus on using correct pronunciation and making your speech clear. Listen to your recording, note your mistakes, then make your video again. When you're ready, submit your video.
5. Include at least one picture that will help us better understand your story. You can use a PowerPoint or a picture. Include your visual in your video.
6. Your summary should be a minimum of 8-10 sentences long.

Purpose: Why are we doing this?

- You will practice speech giving skills including volume, eye contact, organization, and presenting information.
- You will review and practice using pronunciation features we have learned in class including stress in individual words, -s endings and connected speech.

Rubric

60 Points Possible

Criteria	Excellent	Good	Needs Improvement (Resubmission Required)	No Marks (Resubmission Required)				
10	7	5	0					
Content	Give the person's name.	Explain what the person does in his or her job each day.	Say what the person does in his/her free time.	Say what the person values most in life.	The summary is a minimum of 8-10 sentences.	The student meets all 5 requirements.	The student meets 3-4 of the 5 requirements.	Student meets 2 of the 4 requirements.	Student meets 1 or fewer requirements.
Speech organization and clarity (interesting, clear explanation)	The speech is well organized. The presentation is interesting and a clear explanation is given.	There are some errors in grammar, sentence structure and/vocabulary that can occasional cause confusion for the listener, but most of the presentation is clear.	There are some errors in grammar, sentence structure and/or vocabulary that can occasionally cause confusion for the listener, but most of the presentation is clear.	The presentation is poorly organized and very difficult to follow.					

Volume and eye contact	The student speaks loudly enough to be heard comfortably and the student looks directly at the camera. The student has memorized most of the presentation and speaks confidently with little aid from notes.	The student looks at the video occasionally. The student is reading some of the presentation and has made some attempt to practice or memorize the presentation before recording.	The student is clearly reading most of the presentation and has made little attempt to practice or memorize the presentation before recording. The student is too reliant on notes.	The student's face is not seen during the video at any time and/or the student reads the entire presentation with little evidence that he/she understands what is being read.					
Pronunciation Focus	Vowel Sounds	Consonant Sounds	Linking Consonants to Vowels	-S Endings	Linking -endings to the next word	The student is very clear and easy to understand. Individual words are clear. Student successful uses linking between -s endings and the next word.	The student is mostly clear and easy to understand. Student usually uses linking between -s endings and the next word.	The student is understandable some of the time. Student occasionally uses linking between -s endings and the next word.	Most of the presentation is difficult to understand. Student does not pronounce the majority of -s endings correctly and doesn't make any attempt at linking.
Transcript	Transcript is provided. -S endings and linking are correctly identified.	Transcript is provided. Most -s endings and linking are correctly identified.	Transcript is provided. Some -s endings and linking are correctly identified.	Transcript is not provided OR no -s endings and linking are correctly identified.					
Visual	Student provides a picture.	No visual is provided.							
Total									

Example

Example Transcript

Andy i**s** from Oxford, but he live**s** in San Diego. In his free time, Andy like**s** to read and go running. He also cook**s**, play**s** the guitar, and listen**s** to podcast**s**. He avoid**s** eating meat because meat production hurt**s** the environment. Andy i**s** a farmer. He drive**s** a pickup truck. Everyday he work**s** outside. He plant**s** and water**s** crop**s**. He also pull**s** weed**s** and doe**s** harvesting, and he repair**s** fenc**es**. He love**s** working outside and taking lot**s** of fresh air. Andy teach**es** other farmer**s** about sustainable agriculture. He want**s** to teach them how to protect the environment.

(Picture: a picture of the above transcript with -s endings and linking marked)

Analyze for Organization

What information is included in the summary about Andy? Take notes in the table below. You do not need to write complete sentences.

Questions	Your notes		
Background information:	Name	Where's he from?	Where does he live?
Hobbies:			

Food:	What does he like/not like?	What does he eat/not eat?	
Job:	What's his job?	What does he do every day?	Why does he like his job?
Values:	What is important to Andy?		
Other:	Did you learn any additional, important, or interesting information about him?		

Brainstorm/Plan

Watch the video interview you made for Part 1 of the Unit 2 Project. Take notes on the important or interesting information you learned from your interview. Note: If you didn't get enough information from the first interview, you might want to go back and ask your interviewee more questions.

Questions	Your notes		
Background information:	Name	Where's he/she from?	Where does he/she live?
Hobbies:			
Food:	What does he/she like/not like?	What does he/she eat/not eat?	
Job:	What's his/her job?	What does he/she do every day?	Why does he/she like his/her job?
Values:	What is important to this person?		
Other:	Did you learn any additional, important, or interesting information about the person you interviewed?		

Write

Write a rough draft of your summary. Submit it to your teacher for feedback before you make your video.

Post-Project Discussion

Your classmates videos will be posted on an online forum. Watch two of your classmates' videos. Post a thoughtful comment or question to each classmate or group.